



# Prepare and present tour commentaries

D2.TTG.CL3.16

Assessor Manual





# **Prepare and present tour commentaries**

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**Assessor Manual**

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# Table of contents

|                                                                        |    |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|
| Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors..... | 1  |
| Competency standard.....                                               | 11 |
| Oral questions .....                                                   | 23 |
| Written questions.....                                                 | 29 |
| Answers to written questions .....                                     | 39 |
| Observation checklist.....                                             | 55 |
| Third Party Statement.....                                             | 59 |
| Competency recording sheet.....                                        | 61 |



# Competency Based Assessment (CBA) – An Introduction for Assessors

Assessment is the process of identifying a participant's current knowledge, skills and attitudes sets against all elements of competency within a unit of competency.

## ***Suggested Assessment Methods***

For each unit of competency a number of assessment tools have been identified including:

- Work Projects
- Oral Questions
- Written Questions
- Third Party Statements
- Observation Checklists.

Instructions and Evidence Recording Sheets have been identified in this Assessment Manual for use by Assessors.

## ***Alternative Assessment Methods***

Whilst the above mentioned assessment methods are suggested assessment methods, the assessor may use an alternate method of assessment taking into account:

- a) The nature of the unit
- b) The strengths of participants
- c) The number of participants in the class
- d) Time required to complete assessments
- e) Time dedicated to assessment
- f) Equipment and resources required.

Alternate assessment methods include:

- Practical demonstrations
- Practical demonstrations in simulated work conditions
- Problem solving
- Portfolios of evidence
- Critical incident reports
- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Interviews
- Videos
- Visuals/slides/audiotapes

- Case studies
- Log books
- Projects and Role plays
- Group projects
- Recognition of Prior Learning.

Whilst there is no specific instruction or evidence collection documents for all the alternative assessment methods, assessors can record competency in the 'Other' section within the 'Competency Recording Sheet'.

### ***Selection of Assessment Methods***

Each assessor will determine the combination of Assessment Methods to be used to determine Competency for each Competency Unit on a student by student basis.

'Sufficient' evidence to support the 'Pass Competent'/'Not Yet Competent' decision must be captured.

In practice this means a minimum of 2 – 3 Assessment Methods for each candidate for each Competency Element is suggested.

At least one method should provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence.

The following assessment methods deemed to provide evidence of practical demonstration of competence include:

- Practical Work Projects
- Third Party Statement
- Observation Checklist.

### ***Assessing Competency***

Competency based assessment does not award grades, but simply identifies if the participant has the knowledge, skills and attitudes to undertake the required task to the specified standard.

Therefore, when assessing competency, an assessor has two possible results that can be awarded:

- 'Pass Competent' (PC)
- 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).

#### **Pass Competent (PC)**

If the participant is able to successfully answer or demonstrate what is required, to the expected standards of the performance criteria, they will be deemed as 'Pass Competent' (PC).

The assessor will award a 'Pass Competent' (PC) if they feel the participant has the necessary knowledge, skills and attitudes in all assessment tasks for a unit.

#### **Not Yet Competent' (NYC)**

If the participant is unable to answer or demonstrate competency to the desired standard, they will be deemed to be 'Not Yet Competent' (NYC).



This does not mean the participant will need to complete all the assessment tasks again. The focus will be on the specific assessment tasks that were not performed to the expected standards.

The participant may be required to:

- a) Undertake further training or instruction
- b) Undertake the assessment task again until they are deemed to be 'Pass Competent'.

### ***Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System***

The 'Regional Qualifications Framework and Skills Recognition System', also known as the 'RQFSRS' is the overriding educational framework for the ASEAN region.

The purpose of this framework is to provide:

- A standardised teaching and assessment framework
- Mutual recognition of participant achievement across the ASEAN region. This includes achievement in individual Units of Competency or qualifications as a whole.

The role of the 'RQFSRS' is to provide, ensure and maintain 'quality assurance' across all countries and educational providers across the ASEAN region

### ***Recognition of Prior Learning (RPL)***

Recognition of Prior Learning is the process that gives current industry professionals who do not have a formal qualification, the opportunity to benchmark their extensive skills and experience against the standards set out in each unit of competency/subject.

This process is a learning and assessment pathway which encompasses:

- Recognition of Current Competencies (RCC)
- Skills auditing
- Gap analysis and training
- Credit transfer.

### ***Code of Practice for Assessors***

This Code of Practice provides:

- Assessors with direction on the standard of practice expected of them
- Candidates with assurance of the standards of practice expected of assessors
- Employers with assurance of the standards maintained in the conduct of assessment.

The Code detailed below is based on the International Code of Ethics and Practice (The National Council for Measurement in Education [NCME]):

- The differing needs and requirements of the person being assessed, the local enterprise and/or industry are identified and handled with sensitivity
- Potential forms of conflict of interest in the assessment process and/or outcomes are identified and appropriate referrals are made, if necessary
- All forms of harassment are avoided throughout the planning, conducting, reviewing and reporting of the assessment outcomes

- The rights of the candidate are protected during and after the assessment
- Personal and interpersonal factors that are not relevant to the assessment of competency must not influence the assessment outcomes
- The candidate is made aware of rights and process of appeal
- Evidence that is gathered during the assessment is verified for validity, reliability, authenticity, sufficiency and currency
- Assessment decisions are based on available evidence that can be produced and verified by another assessor
- Assessments are conducted within the boundaries of the assessment system policies and procedures
- Formal agreement is obtained from both the candidate and the assessor that the assessment was carried out in accordance with agreed procedures
- The candidate is informed of all assessment reporting processes prior to the assessment
- The candidate is informed of all known potential consequences of decisions arising from an assessment, prior to the assessment
- Confidentiality is maintained regarding assessment results
- The assessment results are used consistently with the purposes explained to the candidate
- Opportunities are created for technical assistance in planning, conducting and reviewing assessment procedures and outcomes.

### ***Instructions and Checklist for Assessors***

#### **Instructions**

General instructions for the assessment:

- Assessment should be conducted at a scheduled time that has been notified to the candidate
- Facilitators must ensure participants are made aware of the need to complete assessments and attend assessment sessions
- If a participant is unable to attend a scheduled session, they must make arrangements with the Assessor to undertake the assessment at an alternative time
- At the end of the assessment the Assessor must give feedback and advise the participant on their PC/NYC status
- Complete the relevant documentation and submit to the appropriate department.

#### **Preparation**

- Gain familiarity with the Unit of Competency, Elements of Competency and the Performance Criteria expected
- Study details assessment documentation and requirements
- Brief candidate regarding all assessment criteria and requirements.

#### **Briefing Checklist**

- Begin the assessment by implementing the following checklist and then invite the candidate to proceed with assessment.

**Checklist for Assessors**

| Prior to the assessment I have:                                                                                                                                                                        | Tick (✓) | Remarks |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|---------|
| Ensured the candidate is informed about the venue and schedule of assessment.                                                                                                                          |          |         |
| Received current copies of the performance criteria to be assessed, assessment plan, evidence gathering plan, assessment checklist, appeal form and the company's standard operating procedures (SOP). |          |         |
| Reviewed the performance criteria and evidence plan to ensure I clearly understood the instructions and the requirements of the assessment process.                                                    |          |         |
| Identified and accommodated any special needs of the candidate.                                                                                                                                        |          |         |
| Checked the set-up and resources for the assessment.                                                                                                                                                   |          |         |
| <b>During the assessment I have:</b>                                                                                                                                                                   |          |         |
| Introduced myself and confirmed identities of candidates.                                                                                                                                              |          |         |
| Put candidates at ease by being friendly and helpful.                                                                                                                                                  |          |         |
| Explained to candidates the purpose, context and benefits of the assessment.                                                                                                                           |          |         |
| Ensured candidates understood the assessment process and all attendant procedures.                                                                                                                     |          |         |
| Provided candidates with an overview of performance criteria to be assessed.                                                                                                                           |          |         |
| Explained the results reporting procedure.                                                                                                                                                             |          |         |
| Encouraged candidates to seek clarifications if in doubt.                                                                                                                                              |          |         |
| Asked candidates for feedback on the assessment.                                                                                                                                                       |          |         |
| Explained legal, safety and ethical issues, if applicable.                                                                                                                                             |          |         |
| <b>After the assessment I have:</b>                                                                                                                                                                    |          |         |
| Ensured candidate is given constructive feedback.                                                                                                                                                      |          |         |
| Completed and signed the assessment record.                                                                                                                                                            |          |         |
| Thanked candidate for participating in the assessment.                                                                                                                                                 |          |         |

## ***Instructions for Recording Competency***

### **Specifications for Recording Competency**

The following specifications apply to the preparation of Evidence Gathering Plans:

- A Competency Recording Sheet must be prepared for each candidate to ensure and demonstrate all Performance Criteria and Competency Elements are appropriately assessed. This Sheet indicates how the Assessor will gather evidence during their assessment of each candidate
- This Competency Recording Sheet is located at the end of the Assessment Plan
- It is the overriding document to record competency
- The Assessor may vary the Competency Recording Sheet to accommodate practical and individual candidate and/or workplace needs
- Assessor must place a tick (✓) in the 'Assessment Method' columns to identify the methods of assessment to be used for each candidate
- Multiple Competency Elements/Performance Criteria may be assessed at the one time, where appropriate
- The assessor and participant should sign and date the Competency Recording Sheet, when all forms of evidence and assessment have been completed
- The assessor may provide and feedback or clarify questions which the participant may have in regards to the assessment grade or findings
- All documents used to capture evidence must be retained, and attached to the Competency Recording Sheet for each candidate for each Competency Unit.

## ***Instructions for Different Assessment Methods***

### **Specifications for Work Project Assessment**

These guidelines concern the use of work projects.

The work projects identified in the Training Manuals involve a range of tasks, to be performed at the discretion of the Assessor.

Work project tasks can be completed through any form of assessment as identified in the Trainer and Trainee Manuals and stated at the start of this section.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Review the Work Projects at the end of each 'Element of Competency' in the Trainee Manual to ensure you understand the content and what is expected
- Prepare sufficient resources for the completion of work activities including:
  - Time – whether in scheduled delivery hours or suggested time participants to spend outside of class hours
  - Resources – this may involve technical equipment, computer, internet access, stationery and other supplementary materials and documents
- Prepare assessment location (if done in class) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Work Projects assessment to candidate, at the start of each Element of Competency. This ensures that participants are aware of what is expected and can collate information as delivery takes place

- Assessors can use the following phrase as a guide (where an 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):  
 "At the end of each Element of Competency there are Work Projects which must be completed. These projects require different tasks that must be completed.  
 These work projects are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X:
- You are required to complete these activities:
    - Using the 'X' method of assessment*
    - At 'X' location*
    - You will have 'X time period' for this assessment*
  - You are required to compile information in a format that you feel is appropriate to the assessment
  - Do you have any questions about this assessment?"
- Commence Work Project assessment:
  - The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
  - Participants complete work projects in the most appropriate format
  - Participants must submit Work Project evidence to the assessor before the scheduled due date
- Assessor must assess the participant's evidence against the competency standards specified in each Element of Competency and their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has provided evidence to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

### ***Specifications for Oral Question Assessment***

These guidelines concern the use of oral questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines.

- Prepare Assessment Record for Oral Questioning. One record for each candidate:
  - Enter Student name
  - Enter Assessor name
  - Enter Location
- Familiarise self with Questions to be asked
- Prepare assessment location (table and chairs) making it conducive to assessment
- Explain Oral Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a 'X' is identified, please input appropriate information):  
*"These oral questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.*

*There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability and I will record whether or not you have answered correctly.*

*We have 60 minutes for this assessment.*

- I will give you feedback at the end of the assessment
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- Commence Oral Questioning assessment:
  - Complete Assessment Record for the Oral Questioning by:
    - a) Ticking PC or NYC, as appropriate
    - b) Entering ‘Remarks’ as required
    - c) Completing Oral Questioning within 60 minutes
- Complete Oral Questioning and provide feedback to candidate
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

### ***Specifications for Written Question Assessment***

These guidelines concern the use of written questioning.

Assessors should follow these guidelines:

- Familiarise self with Questions and Answers provided
- Print and distribute copies of ‘Written Questions’ for participants. Ideally this should take place with adequate time for participants to answer all questions before the expected due date
- Explain Written Questioning assessment to candidate, using the following phrase as a guide (where a ‘X’ is identified, please input appropriate information):

“These written questions are part of the formal assessment for the unit of competency titled X.

There are X questions and you are required to answer all of them to the best of your ability.

You may refer to your subject materials, however where possible try to utilise your existing knowledge when answering questions.

Where you are unsure of questions, please ask the Assessor for further instruction. This may be answering the question orally or asking the assessor to redefine the question.

We have X time for this assessment:

- The due date for completion of this assessment is X
- On this date you must forward the completed questions to the assessor by X time on the date of X
- Do you have any questions about this assessment?”
- The assessor may give time for participants to review the questions at this time to ensure they understand the nature of the questions. The assessor may need to clarify questions
- Participants may record written answers (where possible)
- Participants must submit the written answers to the assessor before the scheduled due date

- Assessor must assess the participant's written answers against the model answers provided as a guide, or their own understanding. The assessor can determine if the participant has answered the questions to a 'competent' standard
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet
- Forward/file assessment record.

### ***Specifications for Observation Checklist***

These specifications apply to the use of the Observation Checklist in determining competency for candidates.

Only an approved assessor is authorised to complete the Observation Checklist.

The assessor is required to observe the participant, ideally in a simulated environment or their practical workplace setting and record their performance (or otherwise) of the competencies listed on the Observation Checklist for the Competency Unit.

To complete the Observation Checklist the Assessor must:

- Insert name of candidate
- Insert assessor name
- Insert identify of location where observations are being undertaken
- Insert date/s of observations – may be single date or multiple dates
- Place a tick in either the 'Yes' or 'No' box for each listed Performance Criteria to indicate the candidate has demonstrated/not demonstrated that skill
- Provide written (and verbal) feedback to candidate – as/if appropriate
- Sign and date the form
- Present form to candidate for them to sign and date
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Observation Checklist.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the participant.

### ***Specifications for Third Party Statement***

These specifications relate to the use of a relevant workplace person to assist in determining competency for candidates.

The Third Party Statement is to be supplied by the assessor to a person in the workplace who supervises and/or works closely with the participant.

This may be their Supervisor, the venue manager, the Department Manager or similar.

The Third Party Statement asks the Supervisor to record what they believe to be the competencies of the participant based on their workplace experience of the participant. This experience may be gained through observation of their workplace performance, feedback from others, inspection of candidate's work etc.

A meeting must take place between the Assessor and the Third Party to explain and demonstrate the use of the Third Party Statement.

To complete the Third Party Verification Statement the Assessor must:

- Insert candidate name
- Insert name and contact details of the Third Party
- Tick the box to indicate the relationship of the Third Party to the candidate
- Present the partially completed form to the Third Party for them to finalise
- Collect the completed form from the Third Party
- Transcribe results/details to Competency Recording Sheet for candidate
- Forward/file Third Party Statement.

The Third Party must:

- Record their belief regarding candidate ability/competency as either:
  - Pass Competent = Yes
  - Not Yet Competent = No
  - Unsure about whether candidate is competent or not = Not Sure
- Meet briefly with the assessor to discuss and/or clarify the form.

This source of evidence combines with other forms of assessment to assist in determining the 'Pass Competent' or 'Not Yet Competent' decision for the candidate.

A separate Third Party Statement is required for each Competency Unit undertaken by the candidate.



## Competency standard

| <b>UNIT TITLE:</b> PREPARE AND PRESENT TOUR COMMENTARIES                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |  | <b>NOMINAL HOURS:</b> 80                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
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| <b>UNIT NUMBER:</b> D2.TTG.CL3.16                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>UNIT DESCRIPTOR:</b> This unit deals with skills and knowledge required to develop and deliver commentaries to customers while on tour                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| ELEMENTS AND PERFORMANCE CRITERIA                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |  | UNIT VARIABLE AND ASSESSMENT GUIDE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| <b>Element 1: Prepare <i>tour commentary</i> information</b><br><b>1.1</b> Identify the <i>commentary information</i> that needs to be conveyed<br><b>1.2</b> Research the <i>selected commentary information</i> that needs to be conveyed<br><b>1.3</b> Classify commentary information that has been gathered according to <i>identified customer need</i><br><b>1.4</b> Develop <i>themes for the commentary information</i> that needs to be conveyed<br><b>1.5</b> Prepare <i>draft scripts</i> for commentary information that needs to be conveyed<br><b>1.6</b> Trial <i>draft scripts</i><br><b>1.7</b> Revise <i>draft scripts</i><br><b>1.8</b> Learn <i>ancillary information</i> |  | <b>Unit Variables</b><br><p>The Unit Variables provide advice to interpret the scope and context of this unit of competence, allowing for differences between enterprises and workplaces. It relates to the unit as a whole and facilitates holistic assessment.</p> <p>This unit applies to staff responsible for developing and delivering commentaries to customers while on tour, within the labour divisions of the hotel and travel industries and may include:</p> <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Tour Operation</li> </ol> <p><i>Tour commentary</i> refers to scripted and consistent information provided to every customer on every tour; also, it includes non-scripted information that is researched and developed to enable responses to questions asked by customers.</p> <p><i>Commentary information</i> will relate directly to the nature, objectives and subject of the tour and may include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• History and heritage</li> <li>• Culture</li> <li>• Art</li> <li>• Natural environment</li> </ul> |

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| <p><b>Element 2: Present scripted commentary</b></p> <p><b>2.1</b> <i>Deliver prepared commentaries</i></p> <p><b>2.2</b> <i>Apply appropriate interpretive techniques to supplement the commentaries</i></p> <p><b>2.3</b> <i>Use appropriate equipment and technology to deliver the commentaries</i></p> <p><b>Element 3: Respond to questions</b></p> <p><b>3.1</b> <i>Encourage questions from customers</i></p> <p><b>3.2</b> <i>Answer questions</i></p> <p><b>3.3</b> <i>Follow-up on questions that cannot be answered at the time</i></p> <p><b>Element 4: Modify scripted commentary in response to unexpected events</b></p> <p><b>4.1</b> <i>Amend the scripted commentary as unexpected events demand</i></p> <p><b>4.2</b> <i>Factor in unexpected events into existing and future standard scripted commentaries</i></p> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Built environment</li> <li>• Wildlife</li> <li>• Domestic and farm animals</li> <li>• Birds.</li> </ul> <p><i>Research the selected commentary information will include:</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Reading site and location specific information sources that currently exist</li> <li>• Talking and listening to relevant people, including visiting communities and interacting with local communities, where applicable and where possible</li> <li>• Organising information from personal memory and personal experiences</li> <li>• Watching, reading and listening to the media, including specific articles and programs on the subject that is the focus of the interpretive activity</li> <li>• Reading books and other targeted reference sources</li> <li>• Undertaking internet desktop research</li> <li>• Visiting museums and cultural centres, including discussions with curators.</li> </ul> <p><i>Identified customer need will be related to individual group characteristics that may include:</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Geographic origin</li> <li>• Cultural background</li> <li>• Age</li> <li>• Educational level</li> <li>• Special interests</li> <li>• Requested coverage</li> <li>• Issues that emerge as a trend in feedback that is received.</li> </ul> |
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|  | <p><i>Themes for the commentary information</i> should relate to:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Identified customer need</li> <li>• Unique characteristics of the tour</li> <li>• Seasonal influences</li> <li>• Time of day.</li> </ul> <p><i>Prepare draft scripts</i> should relate to:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Ensuring currency and accuracy, including a total ban on fabrication of facts</li> <li>• Ensuring comprehensive and relevant information</li> <li>• Including necessary safety and security information relevant to the tour, time of day, conditions</li> <li>• Ordering the information in logical sequence</li> <li>• Preparing sufficient appropriate depth and breadth of information</li> <li>• Identifying delivery style</li> <li>• Matching words, phrases and terminology to the identified needs of customers</li> <li>• Explaining unfamiliar terms, abbreviations and acronyms</li> <li>• Including an interpretive orientation to the script</li> <li>• Checking grammar</li> <li>• Ensuring that language used does not give offence, including unintended offence in relation to gender, culture, race, age or personal characteristics</li> <li>• Matching the length of the script to the duration of the activity, or tour, it is to accompany</li> <li>• Providing an appropriate mix of statistical and qualitative information</li> <li>• Ensuring the commentary explains and translates the characteristics, significance and features of the tour.</li> </ul> |
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|  | <p><i>Trial draft scripts</i> may include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Conducting an off-tour timed trial of the draft scripted commentary</li> <li>• Presenting the draft scripted commentary to co-workers for their feedback</li> <li>• Presenting the draft scripted commentary to selected customers for their feedback.</li> </ul> <p><i>Revise draft scripts</i> must include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Amending the draft script in line with legitimate feedback</li> <li>• Deleting material deemed as irrelevant, inaccurate, misleading, offensive or out of date</li> <li>• Supplementing material deemed to be incomplete</li> <li>• Adding material deemed to be important but missing</li> <li>• Correcting grammar and language related issues</li> <li>• Conducting a further trial of the revised draft scripted commentary.</li> </ul> <p><i>Learn ancillary information</i> may include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Studying material additional to scripted commentary information in order to enable responses to questions from customers</li> <li>• Conducting self-test activities</li> <li>• Updating personal knowledge on the basis of new information sourced, events arising and personal experience.</li> </ul> <p><i>Deliver prepared commentaries</i> must include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Presenting the scripted commentary as written</li> <li>• Delivering the entire commentary</li> <li>• Adding personal embellishments to impart individual style without altering the accuracy and material content of the scripted commentary</li> <li>• Delivering commentary to coincide with activities, or sites being visited</li> </ul> |
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|  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Integrating responses to questions from customers into the presentation of the commentary</li> <li>• Using appropriate voice, including consideration of volume, tone, pitch, clarity, diction and pronunciation.</li> </ul> <p><i>Appropriate interpretive techniques may relate to:</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Engaging participants through the manner in which the commentary is presented</li> <li>• Attributing local and cultural meaning to sites, sights and activities</li> <li>• Facilitating learning, understanding and awareness</li> <li>• Contextualising the tour/activities within a local framework and flavour</li> <li>• Generating respect and appreciation for the local customs, history and people</li> <li>• Provoking curiosity, thought and encouraging personal reflection</li> <li>• Bringing the tour to life by providing opportunities for learning and participation</li> <li>• Building a relationship between the tour groups and the environment/focus of the tour.</li> </ul> <p><i>Equipment and technology must embrace mobile and fixed items and may include:</i></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Microphone including the use of correct microphone techniques in conjunction with a range of different microphones</li> <li>• Megaphone</li> <li>• Laser pointers to direct attention to the focus of the commentary</li> <li>• Sound systems</li> <li>• Lectern</li> <li>• Integrated audio-visual systems.</li> </ul> |
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|  | <p><i>Encourage questions</i> may include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Asking customers to ask questions</li><li>• Demonstrating willingness to answer questions by the way they are handled</li><li>• Thanking customers for asking questions</li><li>• Involving other customers in the question/answer</li><li>• Inviting follow-up and supplementary questions</li><li>• Encouraging the tour guide to ask questions of the tour group members</li><li>• Including the use of humour, where appropriate</li><li>• Using appropriate body language to support the verbal message regarding encouragement of questions.</li></ul> <p><i>Answer questions</i> may include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Using polite and respectful language, including the use of humour, where appropriate</li><li>• Providing a full and honest answer, including the absence of fabrication of answers</li><li>• Ensuring that personal opinion in an answer is specifically identified as such and not offered as fact</li><li>• Presenting answers to individuals and/or groups</li><li>• Checking that the response has answered the question to satisfaction of the customer.</li></ul> <p><i>Follow-up on questions that cannot be answered</i> may include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Referring customers to sources that may provide the relevant information at the conclusion of the tour</li><li>• Asking if other tour group members are able to supply the answer</li><li>• Making arrangements to research the question and pass it on at a later time/after the tour.</li></ul> |
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|  | <p><i>Amend the scripted commentary</i> may include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Assessing whether or not the scripted commentary should be modified</li><li>• Omitting certain information with a focus on non-essential or ‘nice to know’ information rather than important or ‘must know’ information</li><li>• Speeding up the pace of delivery</li><li>• Abandoning the scripted commentary</li><li>• Limiting the number of questions from customers</li><li>• Delivering the commentary without the assistance of voice projection/amplification equipment and systems</li><li>• Apologising to customers, where appropriate</li><li>• Making arrangements for compensation, where appropriate.</li></ul> <p><i>Unexpected events</i> may include:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Systems failure, including technical and equipment failure</li><li>• Injury, accident or death</li><li>• Adverse weather conditions, including the impact of adverse weather conditions in a near-by or associated area</li><li>• Inappropriate customer behaviour</li><li>• Unpredictable animal behaviour</li><li>• Cultural considerations</li><li>• Sudden closures, change of access</li><li>• Closures of sites and unannounced restricted access to traditional areas</li><li>• Reassessment of customer wants, needs and/or preferences while on tour.</li></ul> |
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|  | <p><b>Assessment Guide</b></p> <p>The following skills and knowledge must be assessed as part of this unit:</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Enterprise policies and procedures in regard to preparing and presenting tour commentaries and responding to questions asked by customers while on tour</li> <li>• Principles of interpretive guiding and interpretive activities</li> <li>• Ability to use verbal communication and questioning techniques</li> <li>• Ability to use a range of public address systems and equipment</li> <li>• Ability to identify tour group characteristics and undertake a variety of research techniques to source relevant information</li> <li>• Voice projection abilities</li> <li>• General supporting knowledge to supplement scripted commentaries.</li> </ul> <p><b>Linkages To Other Units</b></p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Develop and update tourism industry knowledge</li> <li>• Follow safety and security procedures</li> <li>• Work as a tour guide</li> <li>• Allocate tour resources</li> <li>• Conduct interpretive activities in the field</li> <li>• Coordinate and operate a day-tour (or short excursions)</li> <li>• Demonstrate/observe respect for indigenous cultures</li> <li>• Manage and facilitate an extended tour experience</li> <li>• Research and share information on indigenous cultures</li> <li>• Prepare and present tour commentaries</li> <li>• Develop interpretive content for eco-tourism activities</li> </ul> |
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- Develop and monitor culturally appropriate tourism activity
- Plan, develop and evaluate interpretive activities.

### **Critical Aspects of Assessment**

Evidence of the following is essential:

- Understanding of host enterprise policies and procedures in regard to preparing and presenting tour commentaries and to responding to questions asked by customers while on tour
- Demonstrated ability to research, trial, revise and present an accurate, up-to-date, comprehensive, interpretive and engaging scripted commentary, including relevant safety and security information, that meets the needs of a nominated tour group on two different designated tours
- Demonstrated ability to respond accurately and appropriately to at least six questions without notice on two different designated tours, demonstrating through the use of verbal and non-verbal communication, that questions are appreciated and encouraged.

### **Context of Assessment**

Assessment must ensure:

- Actual or simulated office environment for the planning and revision phase and an actual or simulated tour for the demonstration of practical commentary and question answering skills.

### **Resource Implications**

Training and assessment must include the use of a real or simulated tour, real people and real or simulated activities for the focus of commentary; and access to workplace standards, procedures, policies, guidelines, tools and equipment. Note: unexpected events may be simulated.

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|  | <b>Assessment Methods</b><br>The following methods may be used to assess competency for this unit: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• Observation of practical candidate performance</li> <li>• Portfolio of documentation including drafts, revisions and final copy for scripted commentaries, and evidence of research supporting the development of scripts</li> <li>• Feedback from tour group members regarding level of satisfaction with commentaries and responses to questions</li> <li>• Role plays</li> <li>• Oral and written questions</li> <li>• Third party reports completed by a supervisor</li> <li>• Project and assignment work.</li> </ul> |              |                                                              |
|  | <b>Key Competencies in this Unit</b><br><i>Level 1 = competence to undertake tasks effectively</i><br><i>Level 2 = competence to manage tasks</i><br><i>Level 3 = competence to use concepts for evaluating</i>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |              |                                                              |
|  | <b>Key Competencies</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | <b>Level</b> | <b>Examples</b>                                              |
|  | Collecting, organising and analysing information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 3            | Gather information for inclusion in scripted commentaries    |
|  | Communicating ideas and information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | 1            | Present commentaries to tour group members; answer questions |
|  | Planning and organising activities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 2            | Develop scripted commentaries to meet identified need        |

|  |                                         |   |                                                                                                                   |
|--|-----------------------------------------|---|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Working with others and in teams        | 2 | Present commentaries in a group environment                                                                       |
|  | Using mathematical ideas and techniques | 1 | Determine time available for presentation of scripted commentary                                                  |
|  | Solving problems                        | 2 | Amend scripted commentaries in response to issues arising on tour                                                 |
|  | Using technology                        | 1 | Use internet to research commentary information; use equipment and systems to facilitate delivery of commentaries |



## Oral questions

|                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Student name</b>       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Assessor name</b>      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Location/venue</b>     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Unit of competency</b> | Prepare and present tour commentaries<br>D2.TTG.CL3.16                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Instructions</b>       | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>1. Ask student questions from the attached list to confirm knowledge, as necessary</li> <li>2. Place tick in boxes to reflect student achievement (Pass Competent 'PC' or Not Yet Competent 'NYC')</li> <li>3. Write short-form student answer in the space provided for each question.</li> </ol> |

| Questions                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Response                 |                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | PC                       | NYC                      |
| 1. Identify a tour you have prepared a scripted commentary for and explain how you identified the information that needed to be communicated and conveyed on the tour.                                                            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 2. For the tour/commentary identified in your answer to the previous question, what research did you undertake in order to uncover the information needed for the script? What essential and ancillary information did you learn? | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

| Questions                                                                                                                                 | Response                 |                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                           | PC                       | NYC                      |
| 3. For the information you have just referred to in the last answer, how did you classify it and on what basis did you do so?             | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 4. Tell me about a scripted commentary you have developed that featured different themes. What were those themes? Why were they required? | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 5. Tell me about your techniques/practices when preparing commentary scripts. What do you do? Where? When?                                | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

| Questions                                                                                                          | Response                 |                          |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                                                                    | PC                       | NYC                      |
| 6. Tell me about a scripted commentary you have drafted, trialled and revised. What was it about? What did you do? | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 7. Demonstrate part of a commentary you have prepared. Imagine we are on tour - what would you say and do?         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 8. Identify and explain the use of equipment and technology you have used when delivering a tour commentary.       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

| Questions                                                                                                                                                                     | Response                 |                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                                                                                                                               | PC                       | NYC                      |
| 9. Demonstrate to me how you would encourage tour group participants to ask questions during a tour and give me an example of how you might respond.                          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 10. A tour group member has asked a question. You do not know the answer. How would you respond in this situation?                                                            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| 11. Tell me about a situation where you had to amend a scripted commentary to respond to an unexpected event. What were the circumstances, what happened and what did you do? | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |



| Questions                                                                                                               | Response                 |                          |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
|                                                                                                                         | PC                       | NYC                      |
| 12. How did you/were you able to factor in the unexpected event mentioned in the previous answer to other commentaries? | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |



# Written questions

Prepare and present tour commentaries – D2.TTG.CL3.16

**Student Name:** \_\_\_\_\_

Answer all the following questions and submit to your Trainer.

1. What are two distinct elements of a tour commentary?

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2. What are the two main options which determine the content of a scripted commentary are and in what way are they influential?

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3. Identify four ways a person with responsibility for developing a scripted commentary for a regular/scheduled tour can determine what is required.

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4. Identify four ways a person with responsibility for developing a scripted commentary for a custom/private tour can determine what is required.

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5. What is described in the notes as a 'common rookie mistake'?

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6. What four criteria must all facts and information obtained as a result of the research process align with in order for it to be included in a script commentary?

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7. Name four options when researching information for a commentary script.

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8. Provide four examples of what is involved in the series of activities necessary/possible when classifying the information obtained during the research process for a commentary script?

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9. In relation to tours, what is meant by a 'themed tour'?

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10. Give eight possible themes for tours.

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11. List four factors which can/may be used as the basis for developing themes for tours.

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12. List four examples of interpretive activities which may be included into a tour.

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13. What are the five sequential steps involved in preparing and presenting a tour commentary?

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14. What are the two recommended pre-requisites presented in the notes for those with responsibility for developing commentary scripts?

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15. Give four 'tips and techniques' (principles and actions) which should be adhered to when creating a draft script for a tour commentary.

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16. Describe four activities and approaches which have proven effective when trialling draft tour scripts.

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17. Describe four points which need to be understood and observed in relation to the revision of draft commentary scripts.

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18. List four examples of generic activities which may be required when revising a draft commentary script.

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19. Name four reasons why Tour Guides need to learn ancillary information to support scripted commentary material/content.

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20. Describe four ways ancillary information can be learned by Tour Guides.

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21. List four examples of generic pre-requisites which may need to be observed and implemented in relation to the start of tours.

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22. List four examples of basic communication strategies which can/should be used to deliver commentaries.

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23. In your own words describe what is meant by 'interpretive guiding'.

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24. Present four possible objectives of interpretive guiding.

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25. Identify and describe one example of an interpretive guiding activity and illustrate how it could be applied as part of a tour.

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26. Describe four pieces of basic operational advice for users of AV equipment.

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27. Give four techniques to be followed when using a microphone to deliver a commentary for a tour.

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28. Give four reasons Tour Guides are obliged to encourage tour group participants to ask questions.

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29. Identify four techniques which can be used by the Tour Guide to encourage questions from a tour group.

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30. What are the five words that can be used to ask an 'open' question?

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31. Name four tips/strategies which may be used by the Tour Guide when answering questions which have been asked by members of the tour group.

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32. “There will **always** be situations where a Tour Guide is faced with a question they cannot answer”; discuss this.

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33. Name four techniques which can/should be used by a Tour Guide when coping with questions which cannot be answered while on tour.

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34. Provide examples of four actions a Tour Guide might take when adjusting a commentary and the tour for a negative event.

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35. Provide four examples of action a Tour Guide might take when adjusting the commentary and the tour for a positive event.

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36. Describe four options for incorporating changes to tour commentaries and/or tours as a result of unexpected events.

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# Answers to written questions

Prepare and present tour commentaries – D2.TTG.CL3.16

The following are model answers only – Trainers/Assessors must use discretion when determining whether or not an answer provided by a Student is acceptable or not.

## 1. What are two distinct elements of a tour commentary?

- Scripted commentary – which:
  - Is consistent information provided to every customer on every tour
  - Includes regular interpretive activities – see section 2.2 – provided as part of every tour.
- Non-scripted information – that is researched and developed to enable Tour guides to respond to questions asked by tour group members/customers.

## 2. What are the two main options which determine the content of a scripted commentary and in what way are they influential?

- Whether the tour is a regular, scheduled – that is, a tour which is conducted on a regular basis and the tour group members are generally ‘members of the public’ meaning they can be of any age, from any background and have a wide and divergent range of needs, wants and preferences
- Whether the tour is a one-off tour – called a custom tour or a private tour where the need, wants and preferences of the tour group members are often/usually known in advance (or are able to be determined) as part of the planning process and are generally specific/targeted in nature.

## 3. Identify four ways a person with responsibility for developing a scripted commentary for a regular/scheduled tour can determine what is required.

- Reading advertising/promotional materials for the tour – which will describe the type, nature and focus of the tour
- Reading the customer itinerary for the tour – which will present details of where the tour is going and what is happening (in terms of routes, modes of transport, destinations, attractions, activities and other inclusions, timing provisions, accommodation, catering and other tour-specific matters)
- Joining the tours already developed – as a tour group member to experience what is currently being said and done
- Talking to other Tour Guides – to learn from them about what they do and say
- Obtaining a copy of the script being currently used – to see the information already being conveyed
- Speaking with management – to determine their wants, needs and expectations regarding content of the commentary

- Using personal knowledge of the tour route and destinations/inclusions coupled with common sense to determine what should be communicated in terms of:
  - The type of tour being conducted
  - Local events, conditions and occurrences
- Reading feedback from past tour group members – to identify:
  - What they liked and disliked
  - What they wanted but did not receive
  - Areas about which they wanted more or different information
- Taking other tours provided by competitors/other Tour Operators – to see what they do and listen to their commentaries, analyse their content, note their timing and other presentation techniques.

**4. Identify four ways a person with responsibility for developing a scripted commentary for a custom/private tour can determine what is required.**

- Talking to the client – to find out:
  - Their needs, wants and preferences
  - Critical aspects/topics which must be covered
  - Type or nature of the detail/information required – for example, historic detail, comparative information, current statistics
  - Who the people in the tour group will be – that is, obtaining a profile for the tour group (age, gender, interests, background, existing knowledge and/or experience)
- Speaking with organisational staff who worked with the client to secure the tour and determine/negotiate the deal – to find out:
  - What they promised
  - What they learned from the client
  - Interpretation of nuances they identified when speaking with the client
- Reading the contract for the tour – one-off tours will be based on a written contract which sets out the responsibilities on the Tour Operator based on the promises they have made. To avoid being sued (or to avoid a situation where the client refuses to make full for the tour), all these promises need to be met as part of the tour.
- Talking to management – who may have specific additional requirements regarding the tour to be delivered based on:
  - Personal preferences regarding how they want the tour delivered
  - Information they gained as part of the overall negotiation process
- Contacting expected tour group members – to identify what they want covered by the commentary. This is not always possible but can be a very effective way of identifying what is required for specific tours.

**5. What is described in the notes as a 'common rookie mistake'?**

- A common mistake made by those who are new to the Tour guide business is for them to assume they already know the information that needs to be provided as part of a tour commentary.

**6. What four criteria must all facts and information obtained as a result of the research process align with in order for it to be included in a script commentary?**

- Relevant
- Correct/accurate
- Comprehensive
- Current, where applicable (given many facts need also to be historical in nature).

**7. Name four options when researching information for a commentary script,**

- Reading site and location specific information sources that currently exist – as provided by brochures, flyers, marketing materials and promotional leaflets produced by:
  - Destinations
  - Attractions
  - Businesses
  - Activities
  - Local tourism bodies
  - Government tourism agencies
- Talking and listening to relevant people – which can/should include:
  - Visiting communities which will be visited on the tour/discussed on the tour and interacting with them, where applicable and where possible
  - Learning from 'site guides' who work at destinations/locations to be visited – these are the private tour guides employed by the site/attractions just to deliver tours for that specific site/location and nothing else – they always have extensive information about the place where they work
  - Speaking with key people from the local tourism agency, bureau or government agency
  - Talking to other Tour Guides
- Organising information from personal memory and personal experiences this highlights:
  - Personal knowledge and experience is a legitimate source of knowledge
  - Doing this helps identify:
    - Gaps in knowledge which need to be addressed
    - Topics which needs to be up-dated
  - Information which needs to be checked and verified – personal memory has a habit of not being all that reliable

- Monitoring the media – including:
  - Reading travel and tourism sections of newspapers and magazines
  - Noting articles and advertisements in newspapers indicating new businesses, changes in circumstances, industry-related innovations
  - Listening to local radio to note matters and happenings/occurrences of current interest and changes to previous conditions or circumstances
  - Watching the television – to see travel and tourism programmes and relevant documentaries
- Reading books – and other targeted reference sources
- Undertaking internet desktop research – which can include:
  - Visiting and downloading information from web sites of:
    - Destinations and attractions
    - Government agencies/tourism authority
    - Targeted web sites containing required information, as identified during the previous process
    - Watching videos of other Tour Guides conducting their tours – as recorded by tour group members and posted on the 'Net
- Visiting sites, attractions and destinations – and:
  - Talking to staff/employees and management
  - Being a tourist in those locations
  - Obtaining hard copies of promotional materials.

**8. Provide four examples of what is involved in the series of activities necessary/possible when classifying the information obtained during the research process for a commentary script?**

- Organising facts into discrete sections
- Arranging information under nominated headings
- Ordering statistics in date or time sequence
- Contrasting one set of data to another set for the purposes of comparison
- Grouping like/similar facts and detail/s
- Indexing the information obtained – for filing reasons and future reference.



**9. In relation to tours, what is meant by a ‘themed tour’?**

Answer must address:

- A ‘theme’ for a tour is a standard thread which runs through the tour: it is a central objective/topic around which the entire tour is based. A themed tour may also be referred to as a ‘special interest’ tour. In practice, one tour is likely to have multiple themes
- The topics and objectives presented in section 1.2 provide the basis for developing the theme/themes for every tour
- To further understand the concept of themes and themed tours the following is useful:  
 “As the leading cultural tour specialist, Martin Randall Travel has the widest selection of small-group tours available covering a wide range of themes including art, architecture, gastronomy, archaeology, history and music. Many tours involve elements of various themes, such as a combination of art history, architecture and music.” Source: <http://www.martinrandall.com/tour-theme/>

**10. Give eight possible themes for tours.**

Answers may include but are not restricted to:

- Family
- Food
- Sailing
- Polar
- Explorer
- Walking
- Cycling
- Short breaks
- Wildlife
- Overland
- Cultural holidays.

**11. List four factors which can/may be used as the basis for developing themes for tours.**

- Identified customer need
- Unique characteristics of the tour
- Seasons of the year
- Time of day
- Gaps in the marketplace.

**12. List four examples of interpretive activities which may be included into a tour.**

- Role playing
- Different voice techniques
- Story-telling
- Games and activities
- Demonstrations
- Participant interaction
- Sensory awareness exercises
- Use of visual aids, support materials and props
- Use of audio-visual, sound and lighting technologies.

**13. What are the five sequential steps involved in preparing and presenting a tour commentary?**

- Prepare a draft commentary
- Trial/practice the draft
- Revise and refine it as required on the basis of the trial
- Practice the revised commentary
- Present the scripted commentary.

**14. What are the two recommended pre-requisites presented in the notes for those with responsibility for developing commentary scripts?**

- Obtain copies of sample tour commentary scripts which have been prepared by others and which are/have been used on tours
- Talk to other Tour Guides who have developed scripts for tour commentaries.

**15. Give four ‘tips and techniques’ (principles and actions) which should be adhered to when creating a draft script for a tour commentary.**

- Realising the creation of a good scripted commentary for a tour takes time
- Ensuring currency and accuracy of content
- Ensuring comprehensive and relevant information
- Including necessary safety and security information
- Ordering the information in logical sequence
- Preparing sufficient information
- Identifying delivery style and interpretive techniques to be used
- Choosing and using appropriate language
- Ensuring that language used does not give offence
- Matching the length of the script to tour parameters/restrictions and needs
- Providing an appropriate mix of quantitative and qualitative information
- Writing the script from the tour group members’ perspective
- Involving others in the writing of the script.

**16. Describe four activities and approaches which have proven effective when trialling draft tour scripts.**

- An absolute need to ‘speak’ the commentary when trialling it
- Conducting an **off-tour timed trial** of the draft scripted commentary
- Conducting a ‘dry run’ of the actual tour delivering the draft script, aloud, in-keeping with proposed tour/itinerary
- Taping the trial for playback and analysis
- Giving a verbal delivery of the draft scripted commentary to co-workers
- Involving the client in the trial.

**17. Describe four points which need to be understood and observed in relation to the revision of draft commentary scripts.**

- It is a fact of life all draft scripts need to be revised – there will never be a script that does not need, or will benefit from, revision after initial writing
- There is a need to respond to identified issues – rather than ignore them: the most common mistake made by people at this stage is to believe their draft script is ‘perfect’ and cannot be improved/does not require change
- Valid and legitimate feedback from stakeholders and relevant others should form the basis of the revisions which are made – there is no need to make changes just for the sake of change but alterations **MUST** be made where there is a justifiable need to do so
- There can be a need to undertake multiple revisions – just making ‘one’ revision is no guarantee the revised script will deliver what is required, as required.

**18. List four examples of generic activities which may be required when revising a draft commentary script.**

- Adding material as deemed necessary or important
- Deleting, revising/updating and/or supplementing material
- Removing content
- Correcting technical aspects of the script
- Conducting a further trial of the revised draft scripted commentary.

**19. Name four reasons why Tour Guides need to learn ancillary information to support scripted commentary material/content.**

- Paint more context for the tour
- Describe additional features of the host country and areas/destinations being visited
- Answer questions asked by tour group members
- Provide extra detail emerging as being required/necessary for individual parties
- Demonstrate professionalism
- Help build personal credibility
- Promote certain businesses, activities or regions associated with the tour
- Expand on information supplied as part of the scripted commentary
- Meet tour party expectations by satisfying individual need.

**20. Describe four ways ancillary information can be learned by Tour Guides.**

- Actively studying the material generated as part of the research process which was not incorporated into the final scripted commentary – reading and re-reading it
- Conducting test activities
- Writing additional scripts
- Creating alternate presentation options for delivering the same information
- Updating personal knowledge.

**21. List four examples of generic pre-requisites which may need to be observed and implemented in relation to the start of tours.**

- Ensure correct personal presentation
- Be there 'on time'
- Provide a verbal welcome
- Introduce self
- Identify the tour to be taken
- Thank them
- Smile
- Make necessary introductions
- Check tickets for the tour or identity of tour group members.

**22. List four examples of basic communication strategies which can/should be used to deliver commentaries.**

- Ensure visibility to all participants ('be seen')
- Face the group
- Speak loudly enough for everyone to hear or use equipment/technology to assist
- Remain enthusiastic and appropriate for the tour content and as appropriate to the nature/profile of the tour group members
- Begin the verbal commentary sufficiently in advance of a scheduled tour stop
- Focus attention on entire group
- Communicate at level that will be understood by the audience considering their age, education, language, culture and special needs
- Seek feedback from the group
- Encourage questions
- Make the commentary a 'unique' event
- Add unscripted commentary/comments
- Know when to be quiet.

**23. In your own words describe what is meant by 'interpretive guiding'.**

Answer must address:

- Interpretive guiding can be seen as the use of interpretive activities and presentation techniques
- Their use makes a tour for participants a much more memorable experience
- Interpretive guiding goes beyond the basic provision of information which is seen by many as the sole objective when conducting a tour
- Interpretive guiding refers to interpretation of the topics/areas which are the focus of the tour or encountered along the way.

**24. Present four possible objectives of interpretive guiding.**

- Give local and cultural context
- Conduct appropriate and meaningful activities
- Contextualise the tour/activities
- Generate respect and appreciation
- Provoke and encourage intellectual activity
- Bring the tour to life
- Build relationships
- Provide explanations and give examples of information provided
- Facilitate understanding.

**25. Identify and describe one example of an interpretive guiding activity and illustrate how it could be applied as part of a tour.**

- No model answer.

**26. Describe four pieces of basic operational advice for users of AV equipment.**

- Learn all about the items/equipment before they use it to deliver a commentary to paying tour group members
- Practice actually using the items
- Record themselves using the equipment
- Get feedback from colleagues
- Check all items before use.

**27. Give four techniques to be followed when using a microphone to deliver a commentary for a tour.**

- Test the equipment and systems (called a 'sound check') before the tour starts
- Do not blow into it or tap it when starting the commentary
- Hold the mic firmly
- Speak at normal speaking volume
- Set or maintain an even distance between the mouth and the microphone
- Speak clearly
- Concentrate
- Avoid feedback
- Protect the microphone from wind
- Increase volume of PA/communication technologies where need arises.

**28. Give four reasons Tour Guides are obliged to encourage tour group participants to ask questions.**

- This is what separates a guided tour from anything else – such as:
  - Taking a self-guided tour
  - Not taking a tour
  - Reading a guide book, such as Lonely Planet or Fromer's
- Management expects Tour Guides to do this – and it may even be a requirement as part of the Job Description for the position/role of Tour Guide
- Members of the tour group expect to be able to ask questions – and this can be one of the key reasons they elect to take a guided tour
- Greater customer satisfaction will lead to more better outcomes – in terms of:
  - More positive comments made about the tour, the Tour Guide and the Tour Operator in relevant blogs and on social media
  - Higher levels of satisfaction when customers complete Customer Feedback surveys
  - Increased levels of repeat business – where people return for another tour
  - Increased levels of referral business – where people who have liked the tour tell others and they, in turn, are referred by this positive comment and take a tour
- It is an excellent way of achieving a number of important objectives for Tour Guides – such as:
  - Interacting with participants
  - Demonstrating professionalism
  - Interacting and engaging with people
  - Providing information relevant to the needs, wants and preferences of individual tour group members
  - Building rapport with individuals and developing personal credibility.

**29. Identify four techniques which can be used by the Tour Guide to encourage questions from a tour group.**

- Verbally stating to customers they should feel free to ask any questions they have about any topic they want – this should be done:
  - During the pre-tour briefing when the tour starts
  - On a regular basis throughout the tour if people are not asking questions – there is no need to do it if they are asking questions
- Demonstrating a positive response to all questions which are asked – this can be achieved by:
  - Thanking customers for asking questions
  - Showing a willingness to answer questions by the way they are handled – proving they are not a burden, imposition or inconvenience
- Giving detailed answers – as opposed to brief/curt replies: see next section for more on this topic
- Making answers relevant – to the question asked. It is important to ‘answer the question that was asked’
- Involving other customers in the question and/or the answer – for example:
  - By asking “Does anyone else want to know about ...?”
  - By saying “That’s a good question. Can anyone answer it?” or “What do the rest of you think about this/that?”
- Inviting extra questions – in terms of:
  - Follow-up questions on the same topic
  - Supplementary questions related to the topic with of a slightly different emphasis/focus
- By asking questions themselves – if the Tour Guide asks the tour party questions this assists with interactions and also:
  - Encourages the tour group members to ask questions
  - Shows a willingness on the part of the Tour Guide to engage with the group
- Including the use of humour, where appropriate – this always provides evidence the Tour Guide is happy to answer questions
- Using appropriate body language – to support the verbal message regarding encouragement of questions. There must always be positive body language to align with the actual statements made. If there is no congruence between verbal and body language, people will believe the non-verbal communication in preference to the verbal communication.



**30. What are the five words that can be used to ask an 'open' question?**

- What
- Where
- How
- When
- Why

**31. Name four tips/strategies which may be used by the Tour Guide when answering questions which have been asked by members of the tour group**

- Thank the person for the question – this encourages others to ask questions as it shows they are actually welcomed
- Mention the person's name when thanking them – many tour group participants wear name tags which can be used to identify who they are: this personalises the answer and people love to hear the sound of their own name
- Smile when responding – if appropriate – this is another way of showing the need to answer questions is not an imposition
- Use polite and respectful language – when replying, including the use of humour, where appropriate
- Provide a direct answer to the question which was asked – this means:
  - Giving a full, detailed, comprehensive and honest answer as relevant to the question
  - Not avoiding the question or re-directing or re-framing it
  - Being prepared to say "I'm sorry but I don't know the answer to that question." See next section for more on this.
  - Never fabricating answers
- Ensure personal opinion in an answer is specifically identified as such – and not offered as fact. There is room when replying to some questions for the Tour Guide to offer personal opinions as part of various answers (where to eat; a good hotel; other tours to take; places to avoid) but it is important to make sure the customers know which part of the response it is.
- Present the answers to the most appropriate 'target' – in some cases:
  - The answer is best given just to the person who asked the question
  - It is better to include the rest of the tour group in the response which is provided
- Check the response has answered the question to satisfaction of the person who asked it – this can involve:
  - Encouraging another question
  - Enquiring if clarification is needed
  - Asking if illustration of a point is required.

**32. “There will always be situations where a Tour Guide is faced with a question they cannot answer”; discuss this.**

Answer needs to address:

This is to be expected, therefore:

- It is important to never be upset about not knowing – even the best, most experienced Tour Guides encounter situations where they do not know an answer to a question
- Because it is to be expected it is necessary to prepare a plan on how to cope with such situations when they do arise.

**33. Name four techniques which can/should be used by a Tour Guide when coping with questions which cannot be answered while on tour.**

- Apologise for not knowing
- Maintain positive relations with the person/group
- Give information on an associated topic
- Refer the question to the rest of the group to see if anyone in the tour party has an answer to the question
- Refer customers to sources that may provide the relevant information at the conclusion of the tour
- Make arrangements to research the question and get information to customer/s.

**34. Provide examples of four actions a Tour Guide might take when adjusting a commentary and the tour for a negative event.**

- Advise tour group immediately as part of the commentary about the event
- Determine how to respond to the event
- Inform the group of the new arrangements
- Try to replace any *exclusions* needed with similar replacement *inclusions*
- Omit certain information with a focus on non-essential or ‘nice to know’ information rather than important or ‘must know’ information
- Speed up the pace of delivery
- Abandon the scripted commentary
- Limiting the number of questions from customers
- Deliver the commentary without the assistance of voice projection/amplification equipment and systems – if there is a failure of these items
- Be positive and ‘sell’ the new arrangements to the group
- Advise management and any other relevant stakeholders who will be impacted (attractions, destinations, third party providers) of changes
- Ensure tour group needs are still met to the best extent possible
- Cancel forthcoming similar tours/arrangements
- Always adhere to management/organisational policy and practice – never go beyond the personal scope of authority.

**35. Provide four examples of action a Tour Guide might take when adjusting the commentary and the tour for a positive event.**

- Stopping, pausing or delaying the tour – while participants see, hear or otherwise experience the unexpected event
- Adding information, context and detail about the event – based on product, site or general knowledge
- Joining with the group in wondering at the ‘surprise’ happening – and sharing their excitement
- Telling group members about how rare ‘this event’ is – to increase their experience
- Explaining why the event is so unique – given the standard nature of the tour or the area, environment or specific location
- Omitting another aspect of the commentary – so the ‘new’ material can be presented without adversely impacting the schedule/timing of the tour.

**36. Describe four options for incorporating changes to tour commentaries and/or tours as a result of unexpected events.**

- Replacing new or alternative destinations and inclusions for those which need to be dropped
- Adjusting the timing of the tour to reflect changed inclusions and their impact
- Changing the price of tickets for the tour if required
- Updating advertisements and promotional brochures/materials
- Conducting standard risk management protocols
- Obtaining management permission for the changes
- Revising and re-writing the script for the commentary
- Notifying other Tour Guides of the revision/changed scripts and providing them with scripts, resources and support.



# Observation checklist

|                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Student name</b>         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Assessor name</b>        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Location/venue</b>       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Unit of competency</b>   | Prepare and present tour commentaries<br>D2.TTG.CL3.16                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| <b>Dates of observation</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| <b>Instructions</b>         | <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Over a period of time observe the student completing each of the following tasks:             <ol style="list-style-type: none"> <li>Prepare tour commentary information</li> <li>Present scripted commentary</li> <li>Respond to questions</li> <li>Modify scripted commentary in response to unexpected events</li> </ol> </li> <li>Enter the date on which the tasks were undertaken</li> <li>Place a tick in the box to show they completed each aspect of the task to the standard expected in the enterprise</li> <li>Complete the feedback sections of the form, if required.</li> </ol> |

| Did the candidate                                                                            | Yes                      | No                       |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Element 1: Prepare tour commentary information</b>                                        |                          |                          |
| Identify the commentary information that needs to be conveyed                                | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Research the selected commentary information that needs to be conveyed                       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Classify commentary information that has been gathered according to identified customer need | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Develop themes for the commentary information that needs to be conveyed                      | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Prepare draft scripts for commentary information that needs to be conveyed                   | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Trial draft scripts                                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Revise draft scripts                                                                         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

| Did the candidate                                                                   | Yes                      | No                       |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| Learn ancillary information                                                         | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <b>Element 2: Present scripted commentary</b>                                       |                          |                          |
| Deliver prepared commentaries                                                       | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Apply appropriate interpretive techniques to supplement the commentaries            | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Use appropriate equipment and technology to deliver the commentaries                | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <b>Element 3: Respond to questions</b>                                              |                          |                          |
| Encourage questions from customers                                                  | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Answer questions                                                                    | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Follow-up on questions that cannot be answered at the time                          | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <b>Element 4: Modify scripted commentary in response to unexpected events</b>       |                          |                          |
| Amend the scripted commentary as unexpected events demand                           | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Factor in unexpected events into existing and future standard scripted commentaries | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| <b>Did the student's overall performance meet the standard?</b>                     | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**Feedback to student and trainer/assessor****Strengths:****Improvements needed:****General comments:****Candidate signature****Date****Assessor signature****Date**





# Third Party Statement

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                          |                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Student name:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                          |                          |
| <b>Name of third party:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | <b>Contact no:</b>       |                          |
| <b>Relationship to student:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <input type="checkbox"/> Employer <input type="checkbox"/> Supervisor <input type="checkbox"/> Colleague <input type="checkbox"/> Other<br><i>Please specify: _____</i><br><i>Please do not complete the form if you are a relative, close friend or have a conflict of interest]</i> |                          |                          |
| <b>Unit of competency:</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Prepare and present tour commentaries<br>D2.TTG.CL3.16                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                          |                          |
| The student is being assessed against industry competency standards and we are seeking your support in the judgement of their competence.<br>Please answer these questions as a record of their performance while working with you.<br>Thank you for your time. |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                          |                          |
| <b>Do you believe the trainee has demonstrated the following skills?</b><br><i>(tick the correct response]</i>                                                                                                                                                  | <b>Yes</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | <b>No</b>                | <b>Not sure</b>          |
| Researches, develops, trials and revises tour commentary information/scripts                                                                                                                                                                                    | <input type="checkbox"/>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Develops themes for commentaries and tours                                                                                                                                                                                                                      | <input type="checkbox"/>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Presents tour commentaries applying appropriate interpersonal techniques while using suitable equipment and technology                                                                                                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Encourages and responds to questions from tour group members following up on questions which cannot be answered at the time                                                                                                                                     | <input type="checkbox"/>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Amends scripted commentaries to accommodate unexpected events and factors such events into future scripts/commentaries                                                                                                                                          | <input type="checkbox"/>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <input type="checkbox"/> | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**Comments/feedback from Third Party to Trainer/Assessor:**

**Third party signature:**

**Date:**

**Send to:**

## Competency recording sheet

|                                                                                                            |                                                 |               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|---------------|
| <b>Name of Student</b>                                                                                     |                                                 |               |
| <b>Name of Assessor/s</b>                                                                                  |                                                 |               |
| <b>Unit of Competency</b>                                                                                  | Prepare and present tour commentaries           | D2.TTG.CL3.16 |
| <b>Date assessment commenced</b>                                                                           |                                                 |               |
| <b>Date assessment finalised</b>                                                                           |                                                 |               |
| <b>Assessment decision</b>                                                                                 | Pass Competent / Not Yet Competent (Circle one) |               |
| <b>Follow up action required</b><br>(Insert additional work and assessment required to achieve competency) |                                                 |               |
| <b>Comments/observations by assessor/s</b>                                                                 |                                                 |               |

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

| Element & Performance Criteria                                                               | Observation of skills | 3rd Party Statement | Oral Questions | Written Questions | Work Projects | Other |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|----------------|-------------------|---------------|-------|
| <b>Element 1: Prepare tour commentary information</b>                                        |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Identify the commentary information that needs to be conveyed                                |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Research the selected commentary information that needs to be conveyed                       |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Classify commentary information that has been gathered according to identified customer need |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Develop themes for the commentary information that needs to be conveyed                      |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Prepare draft scripts for commentary information that needs to be conveyed                   |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Trial draft scripts                                                                          |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Revise draft scripts                                                                         |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Learn ancillary information                                                                  |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| <b>Element 2: Present scripted commentary</b>                                                |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Deliver prepared commentaries                                                                |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Apply appropriate interpretive techniques to supplement the commentaries                     |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |

Place a tick (✓) in the column to reflect evidence obtained to determine Competency of the student for each Performance Criteria.

| Element & Performance Criteria                                                      | Observation of skills | 3rd Party Statement | Oral Questions | Written Questions | Work Projects | Other |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|---------------------|----------------|-------------------|---------------|-------|
| Use appropriate equipment and technology to deliver the commentaries                |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| <b>Element 3: Respond to questions</b>                                              |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Encourage questions from customers                                                  |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Answer questions                                                                    |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Follow-up on questions that cannot be answered at the time                          |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| <b>Element 4: Modify scripted commentary in response to unexpected events</b>       |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Amend the scripted commentary as unexpected events demand                           |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| Factor in unexpected events into existing and future standard scripted commentaries |                       |                     |                |                   |               |       |
| <b>Candidate signature:</b>                                                         |                       |                     | <b>Date:</b>   |                   |               |       |
| <b>Assessor signature:</b>                                                          |                       |                     | <b>Date:</b>   |                   |               |       |





